never shared with the external world. The ongoing discussion surrounding AI centres around this critical question.

Elon Musk recently emphasised the need for a freeze or moratorium on AI development due to its increasing dangers for societies, citizens, and nations. This highlights the importance of careful consideration before proceeding. Shifting the focus to cybersecurity threats, it's essential to recognise the dynamic nature of the entire system, emphasising the need for continuous vigilance and adaptability.

Q. How does your company stay updated with the emerging security trends and technologies, and how do you ensure that your application is secure?

A. We are engaged with highly skilled individuals, particularly in Germany and other European nations, with a focus on security, and have formed close partnerships such as the one with Intel. One of the critical aspects we focus on is what occurs when data is in the processing phase, computed within the processor. This led to the formulation of our zTOP (zero trust onion principle) strategy, featuring a seven-layer architecture. Starting with layer number seven, we collaborate with experts, including individuals from the US security core community, to virtualise the Linux kernel to make it more resilient. Continuous audits of software are emphasised at layer one, with vendors being encouraged to open up their software for rigorous auditing. Without open source, real audits become impossible, relying solely on trust in the vendor. This approach aligns with our commitment to maintaining control over security and privacy. Layer six introduces confidential computing, where Intel's involvement becomes crucial. We've leveraged Intel's SGX processor compute technology within the VNClagoon suite.

Continuous audits are essential, and this is achievable when the software is open. For security to be effective, customers need the flexibility to operate in a manner that aligns with their specific needs and security requirements. For maximum protection, even during collaboration, customers must have the freedom to operate the suite where they choose. If they are compelled into a SaaS model with predefined hosting, discussing security becomes challenging. For instance, customers in the defence and military sectors are adamant about not hosting their critical systems on platforms like Google Cloud. They prefer to operate independently, maintaining full control over their environment.

Q. What is the kind of issue tracking procedure in this system?

A. We have a fully integrated help desk system, which is even ITIL (Information Technology Infrastructure Library)-based to a certain degree, providing a structured approach to handling processes. Our Indian teams excel in tracking problems and attempting to resolve them independently or escalating them to our engineers. This constitutes the first part of our process.

For more complex issues, our engineers take charge of resolving them. Driving and overseeing this process is a crucial aspect of our responsibilities. We don't simply wait for a community to address issues in an extended timeframe. If external audits reveal problems, we actively engage with the community members', pushing them to expedite solutions. While we can handle many tasks internally, there are instances where we need to stimulate and accelerate the community's response. Time sensitivity is essential; we cannot afford to wait for extended periods, especially when dealing with threat levels three, four, or five. In such cases, immediate action is imperative.

Q. How do you drive and incentivise the community to participate in such exercises?

A. Developers are motivated to participate in the community from the sheer enjoyment of solving problems—an engineering approach. This intrinsic drive is shared by our team members. They are not primarily motivated by monetary incentives; rather, three key factors contribute to their commitment to our organisation —- curiosity, the diverse and interdisciplinary nature of their work, and a multicultural approach.

A steady stream of problems to solve keeps these developers engaged; otherwise, their work would become mundane and uninteresting. Second, unlike a narrow focus on a single product, our developers appreciate the interconnectedness of various products within the suite. This diversity allows them to transition between products, collaborate with team members globally, and broaden their skillsets. Third, the younger workforce is keen to collaborate with individuals from different cultures. Despite initial language barriers, friendships form quickly, fostering a dynamic environment of shared learning.

Q. As a community leader, how do you manage conflicts in such a large community?

A. Managing conflicts within such a vast community involves constant communication. Dialogue, negotiation, and discussion are key components. Whenever conflicts arise, the approach is to initiate discussions through video calls or group chats to address the issues promptly. The VNCtalk messenger was specifically developed to facilitate communication within the community, recognising that developers often prefer chatting over video conferences or phone calls. The emphasis is on maintaining open communication channels, negotiating solutions, and adhering to the company's ethical guidelines, which outline how to work effectively within a virtual organisation with flat hierarchies and a meritocratic structure. END